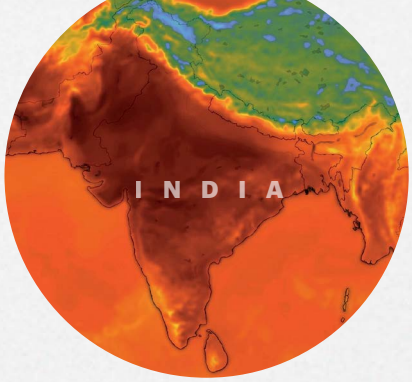
HOW SUPER EL NIÑO IS DIFFERENT

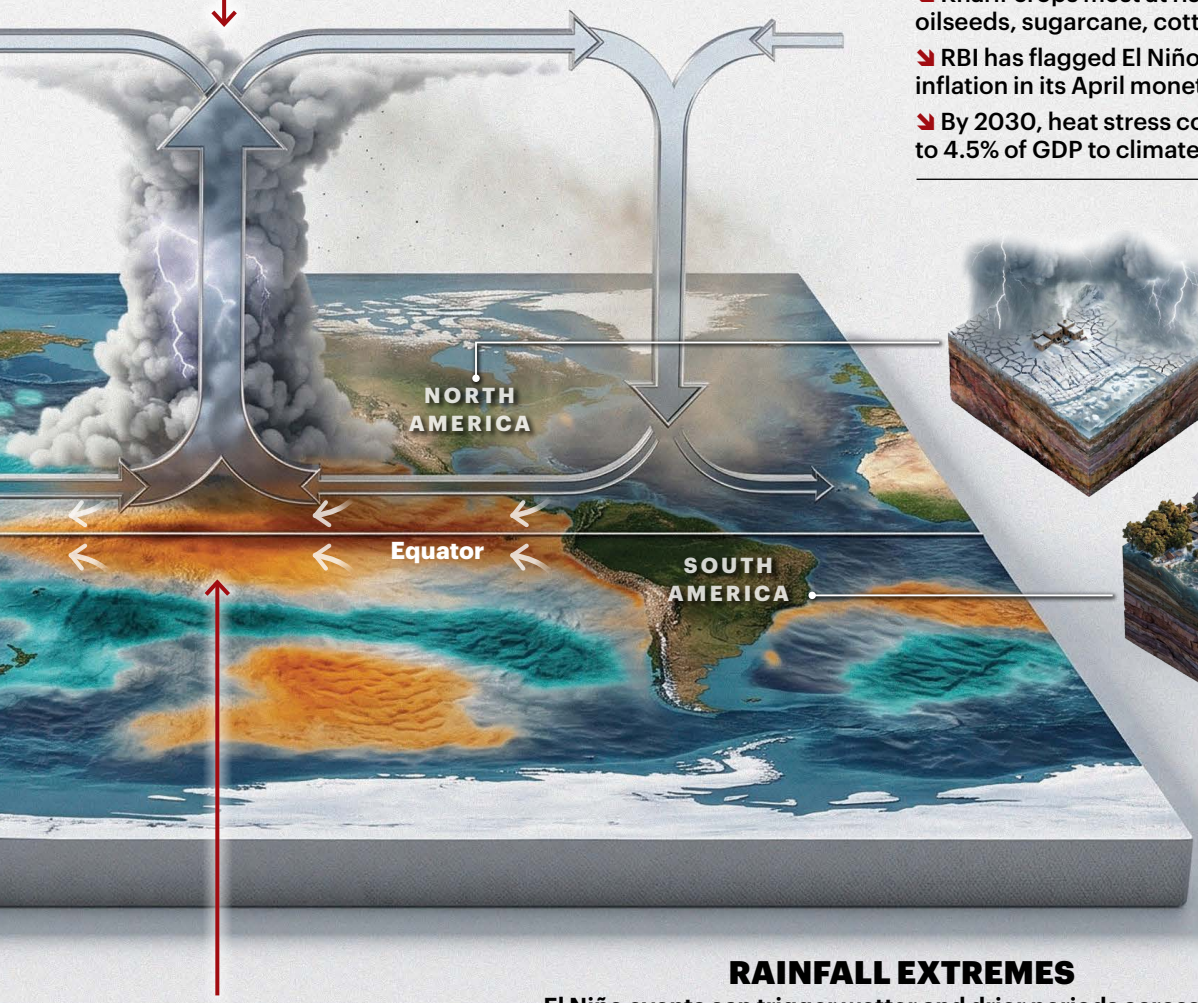
NORMAL EL NIÑO	SUPER EL NIÑO
Sea surface warming 1-2°C above normal	Sea surface warming >2-3°C above normal
Regional impacts	Global, severe impacts
Occurs every 2-7 years	Very rare (once in decades)



LIKELY IMPACT ON INDIA

- Extreme weather impacts jobs, economy; stresses public health systems
- 8% below-normal monsoon in 2026; first deficit season in three years
- Kharif crops most at risk: rice, pulses, oilseeds, sugarcane, cotton, jute
- RBI has flagged El Niño as a threat to inflation in its April monetary policy
- By 2030, heat stress could expose up to 4.5% of GDP to climate risk

3 Warmer ocean surface in the central/eastern Pacific causes rising air motion shifting thunderstorms and tropical rainfall eastward. This alters the jet streams and global circulation patterns, reshaping weather worldwide





NORTH AMERICA
Stronger storms, winter disturbances, wildfire swings



SOUTH AMERICA
Heavy rainfall, flooding, fisheries collapse off Peru and Ecuador

2 Warm water that had piled up in the western Pacific shifts eastward along the Equator, suppressing cold-water upwelling off South America. Sea-surface temperatures in the central/eastern tropical Pacific rise above average, often by 0.5-3°C during strong events

RAINFALL EXTREMES

El Niño events can trigger wetter and drier periods across the world

